



## TWELVE-MONTH PROGRESS REPORT

# Southern Africa: progress report, 2025-08-01 to 2026-08-14

Edition of 2026-08-14 · 33 systems and instruments tracked, 2 of them not held

*Compiled 2026-08-14 from the Data Landscapers source base. Sections run from the region's institutions outwards to what funds them. Each opens with a movement ledger comparing the position at the start and end of the period, which runs to the date of issue rather than to the last month's close.*

Of 33 bodies, instruments and systems on this place's ledger, 18 changed position between 2025-08-01 and 2026-08-14, 9 did not, 4 carry no stated baseline, and 2 are **Not held** at both ends.

Shape check, run before the comparison: 41 sources for this place in the window — 7 in the earlier half (2025-08 to 2026-02), 34 in the later (2026-03 to 2026-08). The earlier half of the window is thin: this is a shorter comparison wearing a longer label, and the movement below rests mostly on the later half.

**Movement values.** *Advanced* — a system entered service, a stage was completed or an instrument was made. *Stalled* — a stated target passed without delivery. *Regressed* — an instrument was withdrawn or neutralised, or a measured position worsened. *Closed* — the programme ended. *No change* — the position at both ends is the same. *Baseline not held* — the base carries no position at the start of the period, so no movement can be stated. A value may carry a qualifying clause after a comma, as in *Advanced, slipped*.

## Summary of the period

On 2026-07-27 the SADC-RTGS [took a second settlement currency](#), having settled in rand alone since 2013; on 2026-07-30 the region's central bank governors [approved regional frameworks](#) on cybersecurity, climate risk and cross-border crisis management. Both are the work of one institution, the Committee of Central Bank Governors.

The community's own digital instruments did not move: the Digital Transformation Strategy remains the [draft tabled to ministers on 12 October 2022](#), and the [2012 infrastructure master plan](#) reaches its horizon in 2027 with no revision on file.

Cross-border capacity was added by operators: a fibre corridor [carrying traffic from 2026-07-06](#), a subsea system [announced on 2025-09-24](#). Where regional coordination is documented over the period, it is COMESA's rather than SADC's, across an overlapping membership.

## Institutions and mandates

### Regional collaboration

| BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM                                              | AT 2025-08-01                                                                                                                               | AT 2026-08-14                                                                                                                                                                              | MOVEMENT          |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------|
| <b>IDEA Project Steering Committee (COMESA)</b>                         | Two meetings since the programme was approved in June 2024                                                                                  | Third meeting, reviewing implementation and risk with other regional communities, EACO, SAPOA, SATA and the World Bank                                                                     | ADVANCED          |
| <b>SADC Financial Inclusion Subcommittee</b>                            | Strategy on Financial Inclusion and SME Access to Finance 2023-2028 under review; Financial Inclusion Information Portal launched (2024-02) | The February 2024 review is still the newest record held; no meeting, work plan or portal update since                                                                                     | NO CHANGE         |
| <b>CRASA (Communications Regulators Association of Southern Africa)</b> | BASELINE NOT HELD                                                                                                                           | Convened its members at the G5 summit with MACRA and adopted the Lilongwe Declaration on Collaborative Regulation (2026-04); no work programme, annual report or harmonised guideline held | Baseline not held |

The IDEA Project Steering Committee [met in Lusaka on 2026-07-30](#), its third meeting since the programme was approved in June 2024. COMESA describes it as the programme's principal policy, governance and oversight organ, and those attending were other regional economic communities, the ICT associations EACO, SAPOA and SATA, and the World Bank. A regional economic community, not a member state, holds oversight of these countries' digital foundations.

The SADC Financial Inclusion Subcommittee's [meeting of 19-20 February 2024](#), which reviewed the Strategy on Financial Inclusion and SME Access to Finance 2023-2028, is still the newest record the base holds of it.

CRASA is the region's association of ICT and postal regulators, and the base carries one item on it: a [secretariat post](#) recording attendance at a continental meeting in July 2026. Nothing it has produced is held, so no position can be stated at either end of the period.

## Instruments and harmonisation

### Connectivity

| BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM                                  | AT 2025-08-01                                                        | AT 2026-08-14                                                                 | MOVEMENT  |
|-------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|
| <b>SADC Regional Infrastructure Development Master Plan</b> | In force since 2012, carrying the ICT sector plan for a Digital SADC | Unchanged, with under two years to its horizon; no revision or successor held | NO CHANGE |

## Cybersecurity

| BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM                                                                    | AT 2025-08-01                                              | AT 2026-08-14                                                                           | MOVEMENT |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|
| <b>SADC central-bank frameworks on cyber, climate risk and cross-border crisis management</b> | In drafting by working groups led by Botswana and Zimbabwe | Finalised and approved, with supervision extended to cloud hosts and payment processors | ADVANCED |

## Legislation and regulation

| BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM                                            | AT 2025-08-01                                      | AT 2026-08-14                                                                                                                                              | MOVEMENT  |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|
| <b>Digital platform governance toolkit (RIA/UNESCO)</b>               | Did not exist                                      | Published with a five-part self-assessment checklist, eight legislative building blocks and a five-tier escalation ladder; no regulator adoption on record | ADVANCED  |
| <b>SADC Computer Crime and Cybercrime Model Law</b>                   | In force as a model since November 2012, unrevised | Unchanged; no revision, successor or transposition record held                                                                                             | NO CHANGE |
| <b>SADC Electronic Transactions and Electronic Commerce Model Law</b> | In force as a model since November 2012, unrevised | Unchanged; no revision, successor or transposition record held                                                                                             | NO CHANGE |

## Strategies, plans and policies

| BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM                                  | AT 2025-08-01                       | AT 2026-08-14                                                                                                                                     | MOVEMENT  |
|-------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|
| <b>SADC Digital Transformation Strategy and Action Plan</b> | Draft of 12 October 2022, unadopted | Still the 2022 draft with no adoption decision on record, though the Secretariat cited the strategy as an instrument it is implementing (2025-08) | NO CHANGE |

## Standards

| BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM                              | AT 2025-08-01                                             | AT 2026-08-14                                                                                                             | MOVEMENT |
|---------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|
| <b>Lilongwe Declaration on Collaborative Regulation</b> | Did not exist                                             | Adopted with six shared principles and seven areas of collaborative action; CRASA has not published the text (2026-08-05) | ADVANCED |
| <b>SADC One Network Area roaming framework</b>          | Reduced rates between Botswana and Namibia only (2024-08) | Six states applying harmonised tariffs, with cuts between 10% and 98.6%                                                   | ADVANCED |

## Data protection

| BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM            | AT 2025-08-01                                                                          | AT 2026-08-14                                                            | MOVEMENT  |
|---------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|
| <b>SADC Data Protection Model Law</b> | The 2012 model law, unrevised, with a modernisation consultancy tendered February 2022 | Unchanged; no revised text and no outcome of the 2022 revision on record | NO CHANGE |

## AI

| BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM                                              | AT 2025-08-01            | AT 2026-08-14                                                                                                        | MOVEMENT                 |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------|
| SADC Regional Artificial Intelligence Strategy and Regulatory Framework | <b>BASELINE NOT HELD</b> | Under development according to Malawi's ICT ministry (2026-06); no draft, adoption date or Secretariat document held | <i>Baseline not held</i> |

The instruments that moved were made by central banks. Meeting at Ezulwini, the SADC Committee of Central Bank Governors' subcommittee on banking supervision and financial stability [finalised and approved](#) regional frameworks on cybersecurity, climate-related financial risk and cross-border crisis management. Central Bank of Eswatini governor Phil Mnisi [said single-country data no longer suffices](#) for regional stability, and urged supervisors to extend oversight to cloud hosting providers, payment processors, and artificial intelligence used in credit scoring and fraud detection.

The Botswana Communications Regulatory Authority [announced on 2026-03-13](#) that Botswana and five other member states — Malawi, Lesotho, Mozambique, Zambia and Zimbabwe — had reduced and harmonised roaming tariffs under the One Network Area framework, with reported cuts of between 10% and 98.6%.

The community's own instruments did not move. The Digital Transformation Strategy and Action Plan is the [draft of 12 October 2022](#), with no adoption decision on record. The Regional Infrastructure Development Master Plan, [adopted in August 2012](#), runs to 2027; with under two years to that horizon the base holds no revision, successor or implementation report.

## Shared systems and infrastructure

### Connectivity

| BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM                   | AT 2025-08-01                       | AT 2026-08-14                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | MOVEMENT                 |
|----------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------|
| PowerTel-Paratus cross-border fibre corridor | Did not exist                       | Phase 1 live and carrying traffic, on a route to link Zimbabwe with Botswana, Zambia and South Africa                                                                                                                                                                                                        | <b>ADVANCED</b>          |
| SADC regional internet exchange point        | No host selection process on record | BoFiNet of Botswana and one Zimbabwean company shortlisted; no award held in the eight months since                                                                                                                                                                                                          | <b>ADVANCED</b>          |
| SADC shared satellite                        | <b>BASELINE NOT HELD</b>            | A technical submission on orbital positions filed with the ITU and the radiocommunication sector met to secure the slot, with a working group created to assess financing mechanisms and payment model; the project is stated to be at an early stage and no cost, launch date or operator is held (2026-08) | <i>Baseline not held</i> |

### Technical Capacity

| BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM | AT 2025-08-01 | AT 2026-08-14                                                                                            | MOVEMENT        |
|----------------------------|---------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------|
| Seacom 2.0 subsea system   | Did not exist | Announced with 48 fibre pairs across the Indian Ocean basin; no route, cost or in-service date on record | <b>ADVANCED</b> |

## Cybersecurity

| BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM          | AT 2025-08-01                                                                                             | AT 2026-08-14                                             | MOVEMENT  |
|-------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|-----------|
| <b>SADC Regional CIRT framework</b> | A draft framework of September 2018, unpublished, with no regional incident-response capability operating | Unchanged; the 2018 draft is still the newest record held | NO CHANGE |

## Data Exchange

| BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM                             | AT 2025-08-01            | AT 2026-08-14                                                                                              | MOVEMENT                 |
|--------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------|
| <b>SADC Agricultural Information Management System</b> | <b>BASELINE NOT HELD</b> | Member-state readiness under assessment with the FAO and the EU; no platform, membership or timetable held | <i>Baseline not held</i> |

## Digital Identity and CRVS

| BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM                             | AT 2025-08-01                                                    | AT 2026-08-14                                                                                                       | MOVEMENT |
|--------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|
| <b>SADC cross-border digital-ID and eKYC framework</b> | A South Africa-Lesotho verification pilot, no regional framework | Federated framework announced for all 16 member states; no build, budget or launch date on record in the year since | ADVANCED |

## Digital Payments and Fintech

| BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM                     | AT 2025-08-01                                                     | AT 2026-08-14                                                                                     | MOVEMENT |
|------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|
| <b>COMESA Digital Retail Payments Platform</b> | Did not exist                                                     | Piloting between Malawi and Zambia, targeting settlement costs under 3% of value against about 8% | ADVANCED |
| <b>SADC-RTGS</b>                               | Settling in rand alone since 2013; 15 of 16 members participating | Second settlement currency live; more than 80 banks, R250.7bn settled a month                     | ADVANCED |
| <b>Settlement currencies in the SADC-RTGS</b>  | One, the rand (since 2013)                                        | Two, rand and kwanza; pula and metical named next, four more weighing onboarding by end-2027      | ADVANCED |
| <b>TCIB cross-border retail payment scheme</b> | A South Africa-Botswana commitment of late 2024, no corridor live | Botswana corridor live through one bank, First Capital Bank Botswana                              | ADVANCED |

## National statistics

| BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM  | AT 2025-08-01                                                                                           | AT 2026-08-14                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | MOVEMENT  |
|-----------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|
| <b>SADC ICT Observatory</b> | Named since at least 2018 as the destination for regional ICT indicators, with no published output held | Still assembling its inputs; the draft SADC Regional ICT Facts and Figures Report and proposed 2030 broadband indicators under review, and MoUs on indicator-data sharing between national statistics offices, ministries and regulators not yet in place (2025-08) | NO CHANGE |

The SADC-RTGS [admitted the Angolan kwanza on 2026-07-27](#), the first currency added since it began operating in 2013 and the second it settles in. Fifteen of the sixteen member states participate through more than 80 banks, and the system settles R250.7bn a month. The SARB's [payments head](#) named the Botswana pula and the Mozambican metical as next, and a SARB spokesperson [told Central Banking](#) that Mauritius, Tanzania, Zambia and Zimbabwe are weighing onboarding, potentially by the end of 2027 — intent attributed to the system's operator, not decisions by those central banks.

Retail settlement moved on a smaller scale. TCIB [activated its South Africa-Botswana corridor](#) in March 2026, through a single bank. COMESA's Digital Retail Payments Platform, [launched on 2025-10-10](#), is piloting between Malawi and Zambia against a target of under 3% of transaction value, from a stated average of about 8%.

The systems SADC would own are earlier. The cross-border digital-ID and eKYC framework [announced in August 2025](#) with Co-Develop and FinMark Trust covers all 16 member states on paper and follows a South Africa-Lesotho pilot; a year on, the base has no build, budget or launch date for it. The regional internet exchange point stood at a [two-bidder shortlist](#) — BoFiNet of Botswana and one Zimbabwean company — on 2025-11-27, with no award in the eight months since.

Capacity that arrived was commercial: the Powertel-Paratus corridor's first phase [went live on 2026-07-06](#), and Seacom [announced a 48-fibre-pair Indian Ocean system](#) on 2025-09-24 with no route, cost or in-service date on record.

## Coordination and collaboration

### Regional collaboration

| BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM                                                           | AT 2025-08-01                                                                                               | AT 2026-08-14                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | MOVEMENT            |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------|
| <b>IDEA programme (Inclusive Digitalization in Eastern and Southern Africa)</b>      | US\$2.48bn approved in June 2024, phase 1 Angola, DR Congo and Malawi; no forum and no regional action plan | <a href="#">Phase I is Zambia, DR Congo, Malawi and Angola, with Eswatini, Tanzania and Madagascar preparing Phase II; a Strategic Action Plan and Digital Action Matrix for 2026-2027 agreed</a>                                                                                            | <div>ADVANCED</div> |
| <b>SADC preparatory process for the ITU World Radiocommunication Conference 2027</b> | No preparatory meeting on record                                                                            | <a href="#">Closed at Luanda on 7 August 2026 with harmonised SADC Common Positions and Proposals on key WRC-27 agenda items; spectrum allocation for International Mobile Telecommunications was named the sensitive debate and the common position document is not published (2026-08)</a> | <div>ADVANCED</div> |

### Digital divides

| BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM                        | AT 2025-08-01 | AT 2026-08-14                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | MOVEMENT            |
|---------------------------------------------------|---------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------|
| <b>COMESA Regional Digital Inclusion Strategy</b> | Did not exist | <a href="#">In drafting under the World Bank-supported IDEA programme, with consultation on affordable connectivity and devices, skills gaps, accessibility and digital trust; no draft, drafter or adoption date published</a> | <div>ADVANCED</div> |

AI

| BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM  | AT 2025-08-01 | AT 2026-08-14                                                                                                                                                         | MOVEMENT |
|-----------------------------|---------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|
| COMESA regional AI strategy | Did not exist | Stakeholder consultation held under the World Bank-supported IDEA programme to inform the strategy and its action plan; no draft, drafter or adoption route published | ADVANCED |

The IDEA programme, US\$2.48bn approved in June 2024 with COMESA leading regional coordination, held its [first annual forum in Lusaka from 27 to 29 July 2026](#) and closed it with a Strategic Action Plan for 2026-2027 — harmonised regional digital policies, standards and interoperability frameworks, and investment in digital public infrastructure — and a first Annual Digital Action Matrix.

The programme's composition has changed since the base last recorded it. The World Bank's [2024 factsheet](#) named phase 1 as Angola, DR Congo and Malawi; [COMESA's release of 2026-07-27](#) names its first phase as Zambia, DR Congo, Malawi and Angola, with Eswatini, Tanzania and Madagascar preparing to join under Phase II.

COMESA also opened work towards a regional AI strategy, with a [first stakeholder activity in Lusaka on 2026-07-14](#). No draft is published.

SADC's own coordination in the period runs through spectrum: its third preparatory meeting for the ITU World Radiocommunication Conference 2027 opened in Luanda on 2026-08-03 on spectrum management, connectivity and [infrastructure resilience](#), ahead of a common position that is not yet agreed. Jornal de Angola reports it opened five days into a cyberattack on Angola's largest operator.

Capacity and inclusion

Access to services

| BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM          | AT 2025-08-01                                             | AT 2026-08-14                                             | MOVEMENT  |
|-------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|-----------|
| Adults financially included in SADC | 119 million, 77% of adults (2024-02), against 57% in 2011 | No later figure held; the 2024 survey is still the newest | NO CHANGE |

Financial inclusion is the only capacity measure the region carries, and it did not move over the window: [119 million adults, 77% of the total, on a 2024 survey that is still the newest held](#), against 57% in 2011. No later regional figure has been published, so the twelve months add nothing to what was known at their start.

Finance

New investments

| BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM | AT 2025-08-01 | AT 2026-08-14                                                                                                | MOVEMENT |
|----------------------------|---------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|
| Botswana Tech Fund         | Did not exist | First phase of GBP 5m against a GBP 50m target, backing pre-seed and growth companies across Southern Africa | ADVANCED |

The Botswana Tech Fund [announced its launch on 2026-04-21](#) with a first phase of GBP 5m against a GBP 50m target and a mandate across Southern Africa; the figures are the fund's own, from its launch release.

The region's headline inclusion figure did not move. The newest measurement the base holds is [February 2024's](#) — 119 million adults, 77% of the regional total, against 57% in 2011. The period cannot say whether the payment rails that did move have changed it, and the base holds no regional financing instrument or capacity programme of SADC's own.

## Where the record is thin

| BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM                    | WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT                                                                                                                                                                                                           | LAST PROBED |
|-----------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------|
| <b>CRASA harmonised regulatory guidelines</b> | A CRASA work programme, guideline or annual report; the base holds one secretariat post and nothing the association has produced; probed 2026-08-05: an April 2026 summit declaration located, not fetched                     | 2026-08-05  |
| <b>SADC regional digital skills programme</b> | A SADC Secretariat programme document or a member-state report of one; the region's capacity work is entirely unheld; probed 2026-08-05: no dedicated regional skills programme found; the nearest is the SADC ICT Observatory | 2026-08-05  |

Five named objects carry no position at either end: a SADC data-protection instrument, a regional AI strategy or position, CRASA's harmonised guidelines, an operational incident-response capability under the supervisory frameworks approved in July 2026, and a regional digital skills programme.

Each was searched on 2026-08-05. Four returned named documents, none of them in the base and none cited above; they are queued for acquisition. On the evidence of the search these are gaps in this record rather than in the region's activity, and the thin sections above should be read that way until the documents are held.

Two further absences have no object to chase. The base holds nothing on Chinese, Indian or Gulf engagement with the region's digital infrastructure, in a period whose two documented external partners were the European Union and the World Bank. And every regional instrument on this ledger is visible through a member state, a central bank, an operator or a lender rather than through SADC's own published record.



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ABOUT THIS DOCUMENT

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